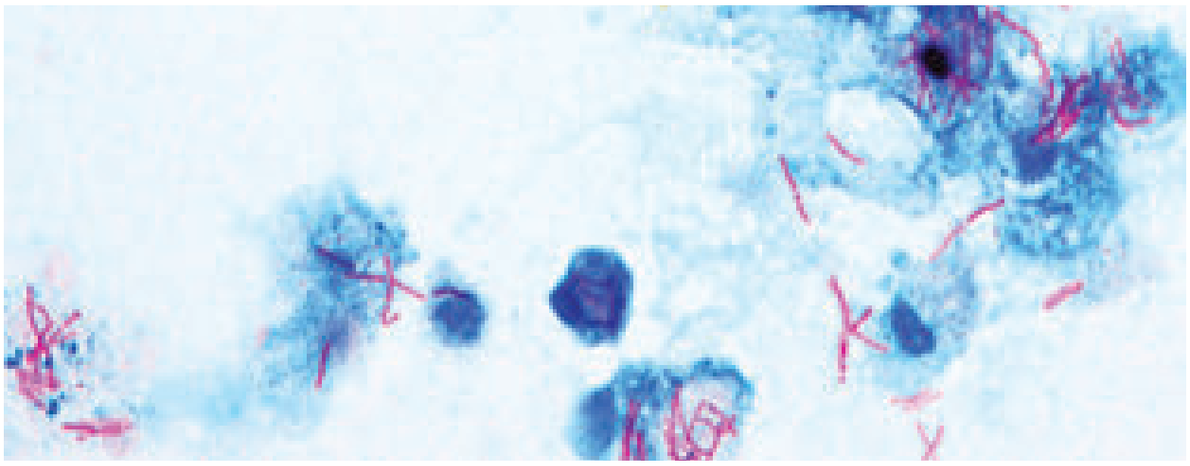
11. Acid fast bacilli

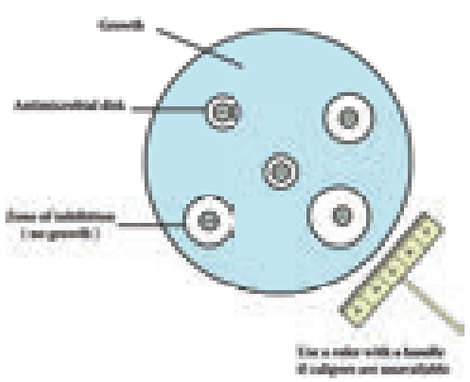


- Acid fast bacilli contains mycolic acid in their cell walls hence do not get stained easily, however once stained cannot be decolourised easily.
- Special method like Ziehl- Neelson's Carbol fuchsin is used to stain acid fast bacilli.
- The acid- fast bacilli are stained red in colour while the non acid fast cells appear blue when counterstained with methylene blue.
- Mycobacterium tuberculosis is and acid fast bacilli.

IIC) Spotter

12. Antibiotic sensitivity plate set up by Kirby Bauer technique

- Kirby Bauer technique is used to determine the susceptibility of the organism to various antimicrobial agents.
- Standard suspensions of rapidly growing test bacterium is inoculated on the surface of muller hinton agar plates.
- Antibiotic discs are pressed on the surface of the seeded plates.
- The zone of inhibition or the zone of growth determines the degree of susceptibility of the organism towards antibiotic.



XII_Micro_Biology_Practical_Manual.indd 312 15-04-2019 17:13:25